GENERAL CUSTOMS DIRECTORATE · LABORATORY AFFAIRS DEPARTMENT

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL · GCD/T/2026/061

Laboratory Information Management System (LIMS)

Central Customs Laboratory, Al-Noor

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Tender reference	**GCD/T/2026/061**
Procedure	Open tender · two envelopes (technical / commercial)
Date of issue	14 October 2026
Bid closing date	17 December 2026, 12:00 local time
Contact	Procurement Office · procurement@gcd.example

SAMPLE DOCUMENT. This tender, the issuing authority and the sites are fictional. The document was created to demonstrate procurement-evaluation software.

Requirements marked MANDATORY are mandatory: a bid that does not meet them may be rejected. IMPORTANT and DESIRABLE requirements are scored.

1. Background

1.1 The Central Customs Laboratory tests about 18,000 samples a year (food, chemicals, textiles, fuels and suspected narcotics) for tariff classification and safety checks. Results are recorded on paper worksheets and spreadsheets, and certificates are typed by hand.

1.2 The General Customs Directorate (the Directorate) seeks a laboratory information management system (LIMS) that manages samples from receipt to certificate, connects the instruments and supports the laboratory's ISO/IEC 17025 accreditation.

2. Scope

2.1 LIMS software for 45 named users: sample reception, analysts, reviewers and approvers. MANDATORY

2.2 Interfaces to the laboratory's 14 instruments: 3 GC-MS, 2 LC-MS, 2 ICP-OES, 3 FTIR spectrometers, 2 Karl Fischer titrators and 2 analytical balances. MANDATORY

2.3 Integration with the Customs Declaration System (CDS): sample requests come from declarations, and approved results go back to the declaration. MANDATORY

2.4 Implementation, migration of 3 years of results from the current spreadsheets, validation, training and 3 years of support. MANDATORY

3. Functional requirements

3.1 Sample reception with barcode labels, storage locations and a chain of custody from receipt to disposal. MANDATORY

3.2 Test assignment by method, worklists per analyst and instrument, and turnaround-time tracking against a target per test. IMPORTANT

3.3 Results entry with automatic calculations, specification limits and out-of-specification flags. IMPORTANT

3.4 Review and approval in two steps (reviewer, then approver), each with an electronic signature. MANDATORY

3.5 Certificates of analysis in Arabic and English, generated from approved results. DESIRABLE

3.6 Records for ISO/IEC 17025: method validation, measurement uncertainty, equipment calibration and maintenance, staff training and competence. IMPORTANT

4. Data, security and integration

4.1 The LIMS and all laboratory data shall be hosted on the Directorate's servers in its data centre. MANDATORY

4.2 A complete audit trail of every change (user, time, reason) that cannot be edited, kept for 10 years. MANDATORY

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4.3 Sign-in with the Directorate's Active Directory, with separate roles for analysts, reviewers and approvers. IMPORTANT

4.4 Results of the instruments in 2.2 are transferred directly; no manual transcription for instruments with a digital output. IMPORTANT

4.5 CDS integration through REST APIs, in real time. IMPORTANT

4.6 Daily backups, and a restore test at least every 6 months. IMPORTANT

5. Implementation and services

5.1 Go-live within 9 months of contract signature. IMPORTANT

5.2 Installation, operational and performance qualification (IQ/OQ/PQ) by the supplier, with the validation documents delivered before go-live. MANDATORY

5.3 Training for the 45 users, and administrator training for 3 key users. DESIRABLE

5.4 Support for 3 years after go-live, with a response within 4 hours on working days for critical faults. IMPORTANT

5.5 Warranty of at least 12 months after go-live on the software and its configuration. MANDATORY

6. Qualification

6.1 The bidder shall have implemented its LIMS in at least 3 laboratories accredited to ISO/IEC 17025 in the last 7 years. MANDATORY

6.2 The bidder shall have an office or an authorised partner in the State. IMPORTANT

7. Commercial conditions

7.1 Prices in USD, excluding VAT. Annual support shall be priced per year, and these prices shall be fixed for the 3 years. IMPORTANT

7.2 Payments follow milestones. Any advance payment shall not exceed 15 % and requires an advance-payment guarantee. IMPORTANT

7.3 Performance security of 10 % of the contract price, issued by a bank licensed in the State. MANDATORY

7.4 Bid validity of 120 days. Bid security of USD 20,000, issued by a bank licensed in the State. MANDATORY

8. Evaluation

8.1 Mandatory requirements are pass/fail. Compliant bids are scored 70 % technical (data integrity and quality 30, functions 25, instruments and integration 20, implementation and support 15, references 10) and 30 % financial.

8.2 Evaluated price = supply and implementation + 3 years of support.

8.3 Bidders shall complete the compliance matrix in Annex 1.

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Chair, Tender Committee
General Customs Directorate

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Annex 1. Compliance matrix (to be completed by the bidder)

For each clause, state Comply, Partially comply or Do not comply, and the section of the technical proposal where the requirement is answered.

Clause	Requirement	Response	Reference in the proposal
2.1	45 named users		
2.2	14 instrument interfaces		
2.3	CDS integration		
2.4	Implementation, migration, validation, training, support		
3.1	Sample reception, barcodes, chain of custody		
3.2	Worklists, turnaround-time tracking		
3.3	Calculations, limits, OOS flags		
3.4	Two-step approval with e-signatures		
3.5	Certificates in Arabic and English		
3.6	ISO/IEC 17025 records		
4.1	Hosted in the Directorate's data centre		
4.2	Audit trail, kept 10 years		
4.3	Active Directory, separate roles		
4.4	Direct instrument result transfer		
4.5	CDS REST integration, real time		
4.6	Daily backups, restore test every 6 months		
5.1	Go-live ≤ 9 months		
5.2	IQ/OQ/PQ by the supplier		
5.3	Training: 45 users, 3 administrators		
5.4	3-year support, 4 h response		
5.5	Warranty ≥ 12 months		
6.1	≥ 3 accredited-lab implementations		
6.2	Office or partner in the State		

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